

Debbie Amewu

Darla Moore School of Business, University of South Carolina,
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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Applied Microeconomics, Economics of Crime, Economics of Education

EDUCATION

2022 - PRESENT Ph.D. in Economics, University of South Carolina, United States
2019 - 2020 MSc. Economics, University of Warwick, Coventry, United Kingdom
2014 - 2018 B.A. Economics (First Class), University of Ghana, Legon, Ghana,

RESEARCH

Working Papers

“The Impact of Decreasing Pretrial Detention on the Criminal Case Outcomes of Violent Offenders”

“Do Election Outcomes of Law Enforcement Officials Impact Public Safety: Evidence from the Sheriff’s Office”

“Gender-Based Sorting in Group Contests”

Works In Progress

“Can Machine Learning Improve Pretrial Risk Assessment? Evidence from Virginia’s Public Safety Assessment”

SCHOLARSHIPS/AWARDS/GRANTS

2025 Darla Moore School of Business Research Grant, with Phil Brookins and Cooper Woodham (\$5,000)
2022 Graduate Assistantship at the University of South Carolina
2019 Ghana National Petroleum Corporation (GNPC) Scholarship

CONFERENCES/WORKSHOPS/SEMINARS

2025 Association of Public Policy and Management, Seattle, WA (presented: Do election outcomes of law enforcement officials impact public safety: evidence from the sheriff’s office)
2025 Interdisciplinary Policing Workshop (presented: Do election outcomes of law enforcement officials impact public safety: evidence from the sheriff’s office)
2024 Southeastern Micro Labor Workshop (attended)
2023 Carolina Region Empirical Economics Day (attended)

TEACHING

Primary Instructor:

- ECON 224 Introduction to Economics (Fall 2025)

Teaching Assistant:

- Public Finance ECON562 (Spring 2023)
- Principles of Microeconomics ECON221 (Spring 2023)
- Political Economy ECON516 (Fall 2022)
- Industrial Organization ECON515 (Spring 2023)
- Health Economics HSPM412 (Fall 2023, Spring 2024)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Research Experience

AUG 2024 - APR 2025	Research Assistant to Dr. Jessica Brown and Dr. Chris Herbst: “Impact of private equity ownership status on child care companies.”
AUG 2024 - DEC 2024	Research Assistant to Dr. Lindsey Woodworth: “The impact of sheriff characteristics on death investigations”.
MAY 2024 - AUG 2024	Research Assistant to Dr. David Fuente:- Projects involved analysing the impact of various experiments to encourage payment of utility bills in several African countries.
MAY 2024 - AUG 2024	Research Assistant to Dr. Orgul Ozturk
MAY 2023 - JULY 2023	Research Assistant to Dr. Felipe Saenz

Professional Experience

2020-2022	Consultant, Credit Administration Department, PwC, Ghana
2018-2019	Associate, Advisory LoS, PricewaterhouseCoopers Ghana Limited
JUNE - JULY 2017	Call Centre Intern, Dalex Finance and Leasing Company, Ghana

LANGUAGES

ENGLISH: Fluent
AKAN: Native

TECHNICAL SKILLS

PROGRAMMING LANGUAGES Python, Matlab, LATEX
SOFTWARE Stata, zTree, MS Office.

REFERENCES

Lindsey Woodworth (Committee Chair)

Department of Economics

University of South Carolina

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Sarah Walfogel

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